DSEH004 · PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT AND EMPLOYEE ENGAGEMENT

Course Correction Decisions and the D1 Briefing

Week 6 · Lecture 3 · Unit I to Unit II · Escalation of commitment, change fatigue, resistance as information, and Deliverable 1

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L3 · COMMIT BEFORE THEORY

Changing course three months into a new PM system shows the first decision was wrong.

Agree or disagree.

Escalation of commitment

STAW (1976)

Knee deep

Decision makers who were personally responsible for a failing choice invested more in it.

ARKES AND BLUMER (1985)

Sunk cost

Past investment that cannot be recovered still drives choices.

SLEESMAN ET AL. (2012)

Determinants

Project, psychological, social and structural factors all sustain escalation.

Change fatigue

BERNERTH, WALKER AND HARRIS (2011)

The construct

Weariness from too many changes predicts lower commitment and higher intention to leave.

In the portal

Change fatigue is one of the things the organization remembers.

Resistance is information

FORD, FORD AND D'AMELIO (2008)

The rest of the story

Resistance can reveal flaws in a change and is partly created by how change agents act.

OREG (2003)

Disposition

Some resistance reflects stable individual tendencies, not the change itself.

L3 · A DECISION TABLE

Scale, correct, address resistance, or hold

CHOICE	SIGNAL THAT SUPPORTS IT	THEORY WARNING
Scale	Early results hold across segments	Regression to the mean
Correct	A specific mechanism is failing	Change fatigue
Address resistance	Concerns are concrete and shared	Do not dismiss information
Hold	Too early to judge; lag expected	Escalation of commitment

Deming's plan, do, study, act cycle treats every rollout as an experiment.

L3 · DELIVERABLE 1

PM Diagnostic and System Design Blueprint

1 **Scope**
Weave your pod's Round 1, 2 and 3 work into one argument.

2 **Format**
300 to 400 words written in the portal by the Pod Lead, with a required Learning Log and an optional exhibits link.

3 **Test**
Every claim rests on data or theory; every design is stress tested against the anchors.

REFERENCES

Sources for this lecture (1 of 1)

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Deming, W. E. (1986). Out of the Crisis. MIT Center for Advanced Engineering Study.

Ford, J. D., Ford, L. W., and D'Amelio, A. (2008). Resistance to change: The rest of the story. Academy of Management Review, 33(2), 362 to 377.

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